Nicholas Brown

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Research Interests

Committees, Voting, Competitive Games

Education

Ph.D., Economics, George Mason University — 2021–May 2027 (Expected)
M.A., Economics, George Mason University — 2021–2023

B.S., Mathematics; **B.S., Economics**, Texas Tech University — 2017–2021

Job Market Paper

Expressive Motivations in Committees
Nicholas Brown, Daniel Houser, and César Martinelli

Why do committee members with little information potentially harm the quality of a committee's decision by speaking? We run laboratory experiments where subjects can acquire information about the correct state of the world, communicate, and vote (with the goal of choosing the correct alternative). Contrary to the simple game theory prediction that subjects should truthfully report their information to the group, subjects frequently report information after not gathering any. Using a logit quantal response equilibrium we find that observed behavior is consistent with a desire to report signals to the group (even if the report is untrue) and a desire to tell the truth.

Working Papers

Price Distortions and Hoarding: An Experiment
Edgar Castro, César Martinelli, and **Nicholas Brown**. BEER Working Paper 2026-02

Mass Reproducibility in Psychological Science
Abel Brodeur, Ghina Abdul Baki, Luna Fazio, et al. I4R Discussion Paper No. 326

Works in Progress

Identifying Exploitability and Exploitation
Minimax Play at Adam's Smash Series (data collection in progress)

Presentations

Conference Presentations

Economic Science Association — *Expressive Motivations in Committees* — Nov 2026
Midwest Economics Association — *Inattentive Jurors: Experimental Evidence* — Mar 2026
Assoc. of Private Enterprise Education — *Inattentive Jurors: Experimental Evidence* — Feb 2026
Southern Economic Association — *Inattentive Jurors: Experimental Evidence* — Nov 2025
Assoc. of Private Enterprise Education — *Towards a Unified Theory of Currency* — Apr 2024

ICES Brown Bag Seminars, George Mason University

Expressive Motivations in Committees	Oct 2026
Inattentive Voters: Experimental Evidence	Nov 2025
Credible Punishment in a Public Goods Game	Oct 2024
A Model of Reputation-Motivated Vote Trading and Its Implications	Apr 2024

Fellowships and Awards

Southern Economic Association Graduate Student Award	2026
Osher Lifelong Learning Institute Scholarship	2026
Association of Private Enterprise Education Young Scholars Program	2024, 2026
ICES Graduate Fellowship	2021–2027

Teaching Experience

Instructor, George Mason University

ECON 306: Intermediate Microeconomics (Asynchrous)	Summer 2026
ECON 385: International Economic Policy (In-Person)	Fall 2024

Teaching Assistant, George Mason University

ECON 886: Game Theory, for César Martinelli	Fall 2023, 2024, 2026
ECON 103: Microeconomic Principles, for César Martinelli	Spring 2024

Professional Service

Workshops Organized

Pre-ESA Presentation Workshop	Oct 2026
Plastic Bag Series, PhD workshop for new research ideas (co-organizer: A. Psurek)	Spring 2024

Referee

Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization

Skills

Proficient: Python, SQL, oTree, LaTeX, Office Suite **Familiar:** R, Stata

References

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